

A BUYER'S FIELD GUIDE

ChatGPT Ads measurement pre-mortem

Before funding a first test, assume the report will look encouraging but still fail to answer whether the campaign created profitable, accepted business. Then close the gaps that would cause that failure.

THE DECISION

Can we trust the first campaign report enough to continue, pause or stop?

If any answer below is unknown, the result can be a number without a decision.

01	What is the accepted commercial outcome? Name the order, qualified lead, booking or other outcome that the business will actually recognize.
02	What is that outcome worth after variable costs? Use the client's approved contribution basis, not gross revenue or an unreviewed ROAS target.
03	Which event will represent it? Record the exact standard or custom event, destination, owner and timestamped test evidence.
04	How will platform conversions be reconciled? Name the store, CRM, payment or analytics source plus time zone, refund and deduplication treatment.
05	When is the report settled enough to judge? Allow for different spend and conversion reporting delays before applying the stop rule.
06	Who can spend, pause and explain the result? Separate activation approval, stop-loss authority and the person accountable for the commercial decision.

Do not use this worksheet to infer access, approval or results. It is a pre-flight decision aid. Actual account availability, fields, limits, policies, reporting and serving status must be checked in the advertiser's own account at action time.

FAILURE MODE REVIEW

Eight ways an early result becomes unusable

Mark each row before build. A credible owner and evidence item matter more than a confident verbal answer.

#	FAILURE MODE	HOW IT FAILS	EVIDENCE BEFORE SPEND
1	Vanity conversion	Campaign optimizes to a page view or weak event that is not an accepted business outcome.	Exact campaign event and commercial acceptance definition.
2	Broken click reference	The click reference is lost through a redirect or navigation, weakening conversion attribution where it is required.	Final-URL path test showing oppref continuity where applicable.
3	Double-counted conversion	The same event is sent by Pixel and Conversions API without a shared event ID.	One test conversion, both destinations, same deduplication ID.
4	Attribution mismatch	Ads Manager and analytics use different windows, time zones or event timestamps.	Recorded 7/14/30-day click setting, view-through setting, time zone and comparison rule.
5	Premature judgment	Spend or attributed conversions are assessed before current reporting has settled.	Named review time and lag allowance; current documentation notes different update delays.
6	Modeled equals cash	Modeled, view-through or unreconciled platform conversions are presented as collected revenue.	Separate platform conversions, reconciled outcomes and cleared cash.
7	Budget surprise	A daily budget is treated as a strict same-day cap rather than an average across the current account-local period.	Budget type, maximum consequence, account time zone and approved total exposure.
8	No stopping authority	The threshold is crossed but nobody owns the pause decision or review time.	Named activation owner, stop-loss owner, trigger, review time and action.

CURRENT DOCUMENTED REPORTING NOTE

Spend insights may lag by about 7-8 hours; attributed conversions may lag about 24-48 hours. Current totals can change as processing completes. Recheck the official documentation and the intended account before use.

If a row remains unknown, record WAIT or CONDITIONAL. Do not let a total score overrule a missing hard gate.

WORKSHEET

Write the decision basis before the campaign exists

Use the client's approved accounting basis. If the value of an accepted outcome is unknown, the economic threshold is WAIT.

A. Commercial threshold

INPUT	CLIENT-APPROVED VALUE / EVIDENCE
Net revenue per accepted order/outcome, excluding applicable tax	_____
Product/service variable cost	_____
Payment, marketplace and transaction fees	_____
Variable fulfilment, shipping and support	_____
Expected return, cancellation or refund cost	_____
Other variable cost triggered by conversion	_____
Contribution per accepted order/outcome	_____
Approved learning-loss ceiling	_____

Contribution = net revenue - product/service variable cost - payment fees - variable fulfilment - expected return/refund cost - other variable conversion cost.

Break-even CPA = contribution per accepted outcome. Break-even revenue ROAS = net revenue / contribution.

B. Measurement record

☐ Primary objective and billing basis	☐ Primary conversion event and campaign mapping
☐ Pixel, Conversions API or both	☐ Timestamped event-test receipt
☐ oppref continuity where applicable	☐ Shared event ID for Pixel/CAPI deduplication
☐ Click-through window: 7 / 14 / 30 days	☐ View-through reporting: disabled / 1 day
☐ Reconciliation source and owner	☐ Time zone, refund and dedupe treatment
☐ Reporting-lag allowance	☐ Consent/privacy decision and owner

Evidence safety: use screen-led or safely redacted proof. Do not send passwords, payment-card details, API keys, raw customer lists, account exports, private ChatGPT conversations or secret-bearing files.

DECISION CONTROL

A stop rule turns reporting into action

Complete this before activation. Use settled signals and the account time zone. Do not treat view-through, modeled or unreconciled conversions as cash return.

STOP-RULE TEMPLATE

At [DATE / TIME IN ACCOUNT TIME ZONE], [OWNER] reviews [SETTLED SIGNALS]. Pause if [THRESHOLD] is crossed or if [MEASUREMENT FAILURE] persists after [LAG ALLOWANCE]. Continue only when [COMMERCIAL OR LEARNING CONDITION] is evidenced.

Choose the honest disposition

GO

Primary event tested; reconciliation source, attribution, threshold, spend ceiling, privacy and owners are recorded.

CONDITIONAL

One bounded fix remains with owner and close condition. No activation until it closes.

WAIT

Measurement, economics, budget consequence, account evidence or ownership is still unknown.

NO-GO

Measurement cannot support the decision, privacy is unacceptable, or plausible economics cannot justify the test.

NEED AN EVIDENCE-BACKED DECISION?

Shastra's three-business-day ChatGPT Ads Readiness Sprint reviews one advertiser, one offer and one market, then returns GO, CONDITIONAL, WAIT or NO-GO. The fee is INR 15,000 plus applicable tax. It includes no media spend, account creation, activation, approval promise or performance guarantee.

shastra.io/chatgpt-ads | hello@shastra.io | cal.com/shastra/discovery

Official source basis - recheck before use

- Conversion Measurement - help.openai.com/en/articles/20001409-conversion-measurement
- Measure Results - help.openai.com/en/articles/20001214-measure-results
- Create Campaigns for ChatGPT Ads - help.openai.com/en/articles/20001210-create-campaigns-for-chatgpt-ads
- Daily Budgets - help.openai.com/en/articles/20001413-daily-budgets

Source facts were checked 8 October 2026. Platform availability, rules, interfaces, budget limits and reporting behavior can change. Shastra AI is an independent consultancy and is not OpenAI, an OpenAI partner, reseller or representative.